Ollscoil na Gaillimhe University of Galway | Institiúid Uí Riain Ryan Institute

ORGANISED BY
RYAN INSTITUTE · UNIVERSITY OF GALWAY



ONE-DAY RESEARCH WORKSHOP · GALWAY · 2026

Embodied AI & *Robotics*

Intelligence in action. Innovation for a sustainable future.

Robotics, Automation and Modelling for Environmental and Sustainable Systems



DATE
Friday, 4 December 2026

TIME
09:00–17:00
All times GMT

VENUE
Engineering Building · ENG-3035
University of Galway · Ireland

IDEAS INTO IMPACT

Where AI meets the physical world.

A day of talks, keynotes and live demonstrations for everyone interested in robotics and embodied AI. Meet researchers and practitioners exploring how intelligent robotic systems can support environmental research, sustainable manufacturing and a better-connected future.

Programme at a glance

Friday · 4 December

09:00	**Arrival & registration**
09:30	**Welcome & opening remarks** Prof. Frances Fahy · Ryan Institute, University of Galway
09:45	**Sensing and perception in mass-production autonomous systems** Dr. Brian Deegan · University of Galway
10:15	**Keynote · Heterogeneous Marine Robotics: UAV, ASV and ROV Systems** Dr. Gerard Dooly · University of Limerick
11:00	**Coffee break & poster presentation**
11:30	**Keynote · Perception and machine learning for real-world robot deployment** Dr. Philip Long · Atlantic Technological University
12:15	**Autonomous material replenishment & digital twins for sustainable manufacturing** Padraig Conneely · University of Galway
12:45	**Live demonstration · Quadruped and humanoid robotics** Dr. Waqar Shahid Qureshi · University of Galway
13:30–14:45	**Break · Lunch & poster presentation**
14:45	**Keynote · AI, Robotics, and Compliance: The EU AI Act and CE Marking** Dr. Julio Zanon
15:30	**Research funding landscape in Ireland: opportunities for collaboration** Research Office · University of Galway
16:30	**Networking, coffee & collaboration**

FEATURED TALKS

09:45 · TALK
Sensing and perception in mass-production autonomous systems
Dr. Brian Deegan
University of Galway

10:15 · KEYNOTE 1
Heterogeneous Marine Robotics: UAV, ASV and ROV Systems
Dr. Gerard Dooly
University of Limerick

11:30 · KEYNOTE 2
Leveraging Perception and Machine Learning to Facilitate Real-World Robot Deployment
Dr. Philip Long
Atlantic Technological University

12:45 · LIVE DEMO
Quadruped and Humanoid Robotics Demonstration
Dr. Waqar Shahid Qureshi
University of Galway

15:30 · RESEARCH TALK
Research funding landscape in Ireland: opportunities for collaboration
Research Office
University of Galway

WHY JOIN US

Connect across disciplines.

Explore **embodied intelligence**, autonomous systems, marine robotics, environmental applications, sustainability, sustainable manufacturing and responsible AI.

Organised by the **Ryan Institute** at the University of Galway.

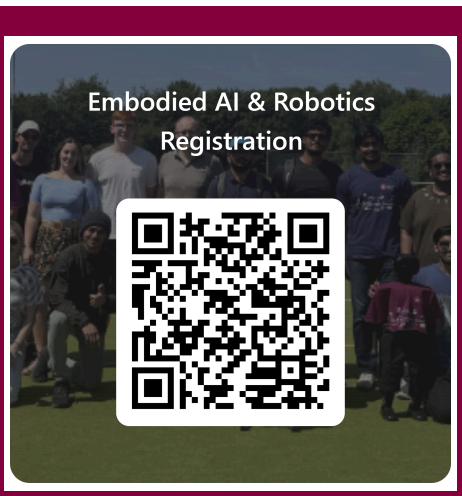
Supported by the NUI Grant Scheme for Early Career Academics 2026.

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Join us in Galway.

Scan to register for the Embodied AI & Robotics Workshop.

Register online · forms.cloud.microsoft/e/hM4VgCTeXN



Scan to open the registration form